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BT EVENT • AI ROUND TABLE



DEMYSTIFYING AI FOR INDIA

Sandip Patel, MD of IBM India & South Asia

» Patel said according to a global adoption survey that included India, 80% of Indian businesses reported experimenting with or implementing AI in some form. However, while 50% of these businesses were ready to scale up AI, others were hesitant due to concerns over costs, skill availability



AI'S BACKBONE

(From left) **Himani Agrawal**, COO, Microsoft India & South Asia; **Santhosh Viswanathan**, MD—India Region, Intel; **Ramesh Padala**, MD & Partner, BCG; **Srini Maddali**, SVP (Engineering & HW Lead), Qualcomm India

» Agrawal said the explosive growth of AI has been driven by the “compounding curve” of three critical forces—compute power, advanced models, and software optimisation. “Infrastructure is not just the backbone of AI; it’s the multiplier that enables scale,” she noted

» Viswanathan said replicating Western models of massive data centres and compute-heavy infrastructure may not be feasible in India. Instead, India’s AI journey must focus on innovation

» Padala highlighted the scale of India’s

challenge and opportunity. “India produces 20% of the world’s data but currently holds the capacity to store only 2%,” he explained. He emphasised on localised AI innovation

» Maddali said India’s semiconductor sector is poised for a major leap forward. “India already excels in design and intellectual property, but there’s untapped potential across the rest of the semiconductor value chain—from wafer development to assembly and testing,” he said.



BORN INTELLIGENT: RISE OF INDIA'S AI START-UPS

(From left) **Palak Agarwal**, Senior Assistant Editor, BT; **Samhita R**, Resilience AI; **Prof Ganesh Ramakrishnan**, BharatGen; **Gagandeep Reehal**, Minus Zero, **Reeju Datta**, Cashfree Payments

» Samhita said AI is a science-driven process which is used for solving some of the critical problems across sectors. Collaborations are the key to developing AI products

» Ramakrishnan said their organisation is working with IITs, IIMs and several other institutes for data collection to feed the model

» Reehal said his organisation is making autonomous driving smarter, scalable, and more accessible for emerging markets

» Datta said the challenge is not about integrating but getting results that could add value. A lot of effort is needed to get to results